# Chapter-wise Detailed Notes — Meaning of politics and its difference from Political Science and Political Theory

Introduction to Political Theory · Unit 1 · Chapter Meaning of politics and its difference from Political Science and Political Theory

Assam University · BA FYUGP / NEP 2020 · Semester 1

## Chapter Study Notes

### Learning focus

Politics concerns the processes through which people make collective decisions, distribute power and resolve public conflicts.

1. Political Science is the systematic study of political institutions, behaviour, ideas and processes. Political Theory is the reflective and analytical study of political concepts, values and arguments.

2. Politics is the activity and arena; Political Science is the broader academic discipline; Political Theory is one of its major approaches or subfields.

3. The boundaries overlap: political theorists analyse real political practices, while empirical political scientists may use concepts developed by political theory.

### Revision checklist

■ Can I define the key concept in my own words?

■ Can I explain its main features and distinguish it from related concepts?

■ Can I support an argument with a relevant example, thinker or constitutional provision?

■ Can I discuss at least one limitation or counterargument?